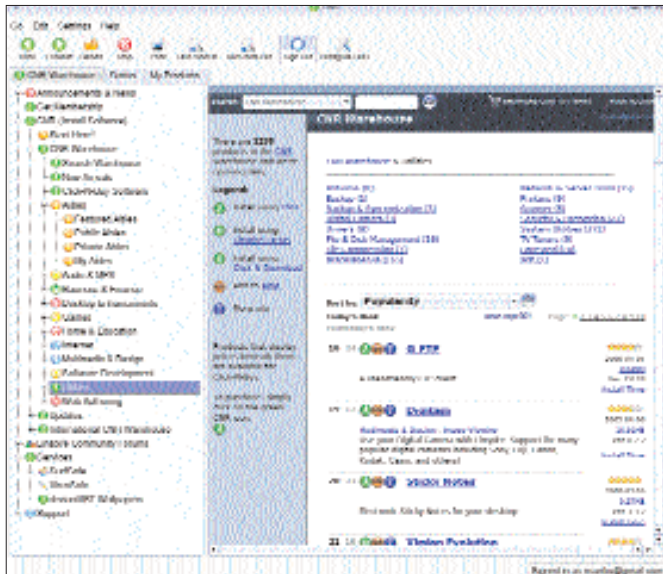




Linspire's inspiring CNR service takes away the pain of updating

are certain entries specific to these two OSes, in general, the structure is pretty same. Linspire has done a good job on giving each section such as Games, Utilities or Office, a different coloured icon so that demarcations are distinct.

The Xandros File Manager is good, and is the primary system browsing tool for file management. The left window pane lists your drives, CD/DVD-ROMs, network folders etc. The most important thing is that you can drag-and-drop files on the CD-RW to backup your files—just as you do in windows XP. Linspire uses KDE's Konqueror file browser, but it's nothing great.

Coming to applications, both OSes offer up-to-date software. OpenOffice 1.1.x is offered by both; though we would prefer to see version 2.0, as it offers features comparable with MS Office. On the browser side, Xandros ships with both, Mozilla as well as Firefox 1.0, whereas Linspire offers a customised version of Mozilla as the default browser.

Linspire comes with the ability to view QuickTime, Windows Media, Flash etc., and we were able to play the movie trailers that offered on the *Digit* DVD. There were two applications that are bundled with Linspire: Lphoto and Lsong. Lphoto is an image organiser and is quite similar to Google's Picasa, whereas Lsong looks like a clone of Apple's iTunes player.

To install more software in Linspire, you need to get a paid subscription of CNR (Click 'n' Run) service. It enables you to search Linspire's repository for a particular application and install it by downloading it via the CNR client. While most applications in the CNR repository are available for free anyway, it is the convenience of installing that matters and hence a new user just has to click a particular software to install it, which can otherwise be a much harder task.

Xandros comes with Codeweaver's CrossOver Office 4.1, which allows you to run Windows-based applications on Linux. You can install MS Office XP, Adobe Photoshop 7, IE 6, Windows Media Player, etc. Xandros network is the tool that helps you organise your installed software, and download newer ones.

Between CNR and Xandros network, CNR offers a simpler and better interface to upgrade and install newer software.

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